A-A-53883
19 June 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FLOSS, WAXED, DENTAL, Flavored, 50 yards

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This commercial item description covers a flavored, waxed dental floss suitable for use in oral hygiene.

Salient Characteristics:

Shall be a dental floss made of nylon filaments, minimally 50 yards in length. The floss shall be coated with purified beeswax, a highly refined petroleum wax, or both. The floss shall be pleasantly flavored with mint or other flavoring material. The floss shall be contained in its own hygienic, durable, personal-sized dispenser, which has incorporated into it a device which permits cutting suitable lengths of floss.

Yarn. The yarn shall be white, bright, high tenacity, continuous, multi-filament nylon. Material identification for nylon shall be in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D276.

The yarn shall be between 790 and 880 denier prior to wax coating. The yarntwist shall be between 1 and 3 turns per inch. The minimum average breaking strength of the yarn shall be 9 pounds, when tested in accordance with ASTM D2256.

Wax. The wax content of the floss shall be between 12 and 30 percent, when tested as specified below. The wax shall be White Wax (USP) or Yellow Wax (USP), or a highly refined petroleum wax, or a combination of these waxes. The melting point of the wax shall be between 57^{0}C and 82^{0}C, when tested in accordance with the USP.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Put Up. The floss shall be uniformly wound on a spool so that the floss unwinds from the outer diameter and each turn and layer is free from entanglement. The floss shall be provided in one continuous length. The floss shall be furnished in a plastic or metal dispenser. The dispenser shall contain the spool of floss, and shall have a cap or lid for opening and closing or, as an alternate, shall be a sealed dispenser with a friction-fit cover cutting device. The dispenser shall have an opening through which the floss may be pulled out and a built-in corrosion resistant metal holding and cutting device for securing and cutting the floss. The floss shall dispense without snarling or entanglement when tested as specified below.

Workmanship. The floss shall be clean and packaged clean, with no dirty spots or stains visible. The floss shall be free from lumps, knots, kinks, fuzziness, fraying, tangling or non-smooth surfaces, and other imperfections which may detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing twelve (12) floss dispensers, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-2. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one dispenser of floss, as specified in this description. Examination shall include, but shall not be limited to, the defects listed below.

Defects.

Dispenser and cutting device not as specified.
Floss not white, bright multi-filament yarn.
Floss not wax coated.
Floss not pleasantly flavored.
Less than minimum length of floss in dispenser.
Floss not in one continuous length.
Floss not clean or has workmanship defects such as lumps, knots, kinks, fuzziness, fraying, and tangling.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one dispenser of floss.

Dispensing of floss. A minimum of 3 yards of the floss shall be pulled from the dispenser. The floss shall be examined during and after dispensing for tangles and snarls. Three additional yards of floss shall be pulled from the same dispenser and examined.

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Wax content. A 10-yard sample of floss shall be weighed on an analytical balance. The sample shall then be soaked in a wax solvent such as ethanol. The sample shall be removed from the solvent. The solvent shall be evaporated from the sample and the sample weighed. The soaking and drying of the sample shall be repeated until the sample arrives at constant weight. The percent of wax content shall be calculated as follows:

$$\text{Percent of wax content} = \frac{\text{Weight of sample} - \text{Weight of unwaxed sample} \times 100}{\text{Weight of sample}}$$

A minimum of 2 determinations shall be made, and the results averaged.

Breaking strength. Breaking strength of the floss shall be measured in accordance with the ASTM Standard D2256 single-strand method.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document.

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-01-283-3709	FLOSS, WAXED, DENTAL, Flavored, 50 yards, (45.72 meters), 12's

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-0SS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

61642

Project No. 6520-2227
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